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The impact of artificial intelligence on how sport is distributed and consumed

How is artificial intelligence changing the way amateur athletes train?

> This is not a thesis about generative AI. It studies the AI that was already inside watches and training apps in 2023: machine learning, video analysis, sensors. Generative AI reached training apps soon after.

226 survey respondents	**76%** want more AI in their training (159 answers)	**40%** say AI improved their running technique	**~36%** say it helps them manage their time and adapt their sessions

METHOD

A literature review of 53 references, from the NBA's work with Second Spectrum and HomeCourt to GoMore and the Stade Toulousain. Then an anonymous online survey on Qualtrics: 20 questions in six parts, piloted first and shared in sports communities. Descriptive statistics, then analyses of variance and association in SPSS.

WHAT HOLDS PEOPLE BACK

- Cost.
- Data that is hard to read.
- A lack of information, and some fear of AI.
- Doubts about the reliability of some advice.

RECOMMENDATIONS

- Make AI affordable for amateur athletes.
- Explain how it works, to take the fear out of it.
- Personalise it to each athlete.
- Collect and share user stories.

LIMITS

No qualitative interviews, an online sample, 72% of respondents aged 18 to 24, and a possible social desirability bias.

WHERE IT LED

Three years later, I built for myself what the respondents were asking for: an AI coach that reads my own watch data. And explaining how AI works became part of my job.

The full thesis, 81 pages in French, is online next to this summary. Questions: alexislekieffre@outlook.fr